

How AI can waste water (even though you can't destroy water) #carterpcs #tech #techtok #ai

Posted by u/Legitimate_Stress237 • 0 points • 16 comments

1. I understand this is not about art, but still wanted to post it here, since it is ai-related.
 2. This is NOT my opinion. I just looked into the AI using water topic, and this video came up.
- So, since the video is clearly against AI, I wanted to hear opinions from the other side before forming my own. Also, please, no rude comments towards me, this creator, or anyone else, even if they are wrong.

Comments

u/Worth-Drive • 1 points • 2026-03-23 21:30 UTC

Carter was getting heat from antis so he changed his view on ai for his videos

u/goatonastik • 1 points • 2026-03-22 08:06 UTC

I think if he added a few more camera shakes and zoomer zooms, he might've convinced someone!

u/28klotlucas2 • 5 points • 2026-03-22 02:05 UTC

So I respect CarterPCs and his channel but he is unbelievably wrong and has a fundamental misunderstanding of the situation, the water cycle, and how water purification works.

Just because the water evaporated does not mean the rain will also be "hot," because it has to make it back to water's point of condensation which is below boiling point, and it usually makes it back to the temperature of the environment it is in or even less. Tell me, when's the last time you felt "hot rain."

Also, when the water is evaporated, the vapors cannot be "contaminated" as he claims. The boiling point of water is 100°C, so anything with a boiling point below that point (most electronic materials and the tubing of most watercooling setups, stays behind.

He does make a good argument when it comes to movement. The water will end up somewhere else, however, more rain comes to the areas of freshwater as well, it's not like it stops raining in those areas. Besides, the water put into the atmosphere isn't even enough to affect local weather patterns, let alone the entire world or even far beyond the local area. Water is expensive, many people who live near AI data centers falsely attribute their expensive water bills to the data centers near them. It's a very classic fallitical argument and it's sad to see many people I'd otherwise see as intelligent fall for it.

Even if these concerns were 100% valid, it still would not consider the other 99.9% of global freshwater usage that isn't AI, and yes, AI is literally 0.1% of global freshwater usage. If you have eaten a burger in the last 4 months, you have done significantly more damage to the environment than an extreme AI user. If one truly cared about the "water shortage," you would not take long showers (pure water wastage), use YouTube (they also have GPU data centers at a much larger scale), or use any kind of animal product (huge amounts of water to feed and raise them).

u/Hightower_March • 1 points • 2026-03-22 14:52 UTC

I couldn't tell if I was misunderstanding him there. Hot rain??

Also isn't a lot of water cooling in closed loops...? Processors lose energy to the water, water gets pumped around a bunch of thin/flat (high surface area) routes losing energy until it's back. Not all cooling is evaporation.

u/RevolutionaryDark818 • 1 points • 2026-03-22 00:38 UTC

Carter is not inherently arguing that AI uses a ton of water. He is arguing that "the water doesn't just disappear" isn't a good argument because most (competent) Anti's know that, and instead are arguing that the water will not always come back down to the same spot, and can become misplaced, contaminated, and raise people's water bills

Carter is not Anti AI If I remember correctly. He uses ChatGPT and other LLMs a lot. He is pointing out arguments on his side that are flawed because he is not a narcissist and can see both good and bad things about both sides

u/Legitimate_Stress237 • 1 points • 2026-03-22 14:15 UTC

Ok, I misunderstood the intention behind the video, then. I've never heard of this man before.

u/RevolutionaryDark818 • 1 points • 2026-03-22 14:38 UTC

No worries

u/RutabagaNo188 • 1 points • 2026-03-22 00:27 UTC

The question is the quantity; AI does not use an insane amount of water each prompt, and streaming uses more. Are we going to stop watching YouTube?

And it's ridiculous to talk about water while energy from oil is destroying the planet; this is completely lobbying by the oil companies. In this case, some tech companies buy functional carbon credits or use cleaner energy, but Amazon, for example, is polluting a lot, and guess who some of your streamings are forced to connect to? but no one talks about that because it requires thinking and searching

(Netflix and YouTube also buy credits just to be fair)

u/pinkreaction • 4 points • 2026-03-21 21:09 UTC

Evaporated water isn't contaminated... or perhaps this isn't something i haven't learned of.

As for the water bill issue, i feel there is a solution to that... and it won't be closing data centres off.

Perhaps closed loop systems for cooling should be mandatory for data centres.

Closed looped systems may demand electricity, and then i suggest data centers make their own electricity whilst consuming from the grid and their should be a percent ratio of how much electricity

they make vs how much they take from the grid.

I am no genius, but i am sure these are very simple problems that can be solved if we really want to solve them.

Or we can just call each other names to feel hood and watch the world burn..... then come up with new names once the old ones go out of fashion.

u/RevolutionaryDark818 • 1 points • 2026-03-22 00:44 UTC

Evaporated water isn't inherently contaminated, but the water coming into contact with the processor and being boiled and evaporated from it and contaminate it.

The "we don't have a solution to that" for water bill isn't very helpful... I'd suggest data centers aren't build too close to residential areas

As for your other points, they are valid and I agree with them

u/pinkreaction • 1 points • 2026-03-23 15:14 UTC

I wrote, "i feel there's a solution to that water bill issue, which is something elon and others are currently doing but not widely to their data centres, closed loop cooling systems"

u/ze_mannbaerschwein • 10 points • 2026-03-21 21:02 UTC

Never trust a vertical video with a frantically rambling talking head.

<https://preview.redd.it/8yfemmc8qggg1.jpeg?width=1169&format=pjpg&auto=webp&s=62fe2a6c160a9d4e57eb4e707a845920fed4406>

u/RevolutionaryDark818 • 0 points • 2026-03-22 00:41 UTC

Did you watch the video? like, at all?

Nowhere in the video does Carter claim that AI uses excessive water and we need to stop it. Infact, Carter uses many LLMs frequently.

What he's saying here is that the "the water doesn't just disappear" argument is not a good one because most Anti's know that, and instead argue on issues such as the water not always coming back in the same spot, the water being contaminate, and water bills being raised.

u/ze_mannbaerschwein • 3 points • 2026-03-22 02:47 UTC

>Did you watch the video? like, at all?

>Nowhere in the video does Carter claim that AI uses excessive water and we need to stop it. Infact, Carter uses many LLMs frequently.

Yes, I sat through the video. Starting at the 0:40 mark, he starts rambling on about water volume and how it drives up your water bill.

u/RevolutionaryDark818 • 1 points • 2026-03-22 03:29 UTC

first of all, thats indirectly saying "AI uses a lot of water!". Second of all, Because it can drive up peoples water bill

Many Data centers are built next to cities. Data centers start using water from the city. Demand increases dramatically, but supply doesn't. Price increases as a result

Simple supply and demand

u/Legitimate_Stress237 • 5 points • 2026-03-21 21:35 UTC

Thank you for your response. Now I'm definitely on the "AI isn't really bad" side. I just felt something was wrong with this video, tbh.

u/ze_mannbaerschwein • 1 points • 2026-03-22 02:50 UTC

You're welcome. Here's another interesting figure that nobody seems to be getting worked up about, but which is enormous compared to the water consumption of AI data centers:

<https://preview.redd.it/ylkdeus2giqq1.png?width=1107&format=png&auto=webp&s=d39e808f3cb8dfe1ee0d6c2cdae3eec73d70da8f>

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2026-03-21 20:55 UTC

[removed]